1. Community Garden Mission and Site Preparation

The Community Garden project aims to establish sustainable local food production , educate participants on ecological agriculture, and foster neighbourhood colla boration. Site preparation requires evaluating sunlight exposure, testing soil f or heavy metals and contaminants, and installing durable raised garden beds. Wat er access must be secured prior to planting, with direct connection to municipal supply or certified rainwater tanks. Volunteers must complete orientation befor e operating motorized machinery or modifying irrigation mains. All garden plots must follow organic guidelines, excluding synthetic chemical pesticides, petrole um-based fertilizers, and untreated municipal runoff.

2. Composting, Waste Diversion, and Soil Health

Healthy living soil forms the foundation of all productive garden yields. Active compost piles must maintain a balanced carbon to nitrogen ratio, incorporating two parts dry brown leaves or straw to one part fresh green vegetable trimmings and coffee grounds. Piles must be aerated weekly and monitored with temperature probes to ensure internal heat reaches 130 to 150 degrees Fahrenheit, effectivel y neutralizing weed seeds and plant pathogens. Animal manure, dairy products, me at scraps, and diseased foliage are strictly prohibited from standard compost en closures.

3. Irrigation Systems, Water Conservation, and Mulching

Efficient water application preserves regional municipal reserves and promotes d
eep, resilient root growth across all seasonal vegetable varieties. Drip irrigat
ion tubing with pressure-compensating emitters is mandatory across all assigned
member beds. Overhead sprinkler systems are prohibited except during seed germin
ation periods before 8:00 AM. A three-inch layer of hardwood mulch or clean stra
w must be maintained over bare bed soil throughout summer months to minimize sur
face evaporation, regulate soil temperatures, and suppress persistent weed compe
tition. Inspect all lines weekly for leaks, line pressure drops, or clogged emit
ter nozzles.

4. Pest Management, Companion Planting, and Beneficial Insects

Integrated Pest Management emphasizes biological control and cultural prevention over eradication or toxic chemical intervention. Companion planting strategies must be implemented across all beds: French marigolds repel destructive nematodes, while dill and sweet alyssum attract predatory beneficial wasps and hoverflies that control aphid outbreaks. Row covers may be deployed during early spring for light periods to exclude brassica flea beetles and cabbage loopers. In cases of severe infestations, organic horticultural soaps or cold-pressed neem oil dilutions may be applied strictly during twilight hours to prevent harming foraging honeybees.

5. Harvesting, Records, and Frequently Asked Questions

Produce harvesting should occur during cool morning hours to maximize crispness, nutritional density, and post-harvest shelf stability. Every harvest must be recorded in the communal field binder located in the primary tool shed, noting bed number, crop variety, and weight in kilograms. Surplus produce exceeding household consumption limits must be deposited in the community cold locker for weekly delivery to the neighbourhood food pantry. Frequently asked questions regarding access keys, annual dues, tool repair schedules, and monthly work bees are posted on the notice board. Respect shared spaces, sanitize hand shears after each use, and report broken hose fittings to the site coordinator immediately.